

7 AI Prompts Every Nonprofit Marketer Should Steal

Copy-and-paste prompts that save 10+ hours a week
on fundraising copy, donor emails, and campaign content.

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Before You Start

Most people use AI wrong for marketing. They type something generic, get generic output, and conclude the tool is overhyped.

The problem is never the tool. It is the instruction.

I run a digital marketing consultancy for mission-driven organizations. AI is embedded in every part of my workflow. Not as a novelty. As infrastructure. I use it to write donor emails, audit client websites, build automation workflows, train internal copywriting bots, and produce content that has to perform against real revenue targets.

These 7 prompts are the ones I return to most often. They are not theoretical. Each one has been tested in live campaigns, refined through real client work, and structured to produce output you can actually use without heavy editing.

A few ground rules that make these work:

Give context before you give instructions. Paste in your brand voice, your audience description, and examples of your best work before you ask for anything. The more Claude knows about you, the less you have to fix afterward.

Ask for 3 variations. The first output is usually the safest. The third is usually the sharpest. Always generate options.

Use Claude Projects. Upload your brand guidelines, voice profile, and best-performing content once. Every conversation inside that project will reference it automatically. No more re-explaining who you are.

Treat AI as a first-draft machine, not a final-draft machine. These prompts get you 80% of the way in 10% of the time. Your expertise finishes the last 20%.

Now, the prompts.

01

The Language Miner

Extract the exact words your donors and supporters use so your copy sounds like it read their minds.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Your audience does not describe their problems the way you describe them. They use different words, different emotional frames, different metaphors. The best-performing fundraising copy does not sound like it was written by a marketing team. It sounds like a conversation your donor is already having in their own head. This prompt mines that language from real feedback so you can mirror it back.

THE PROMPT

I am going to paste in [10-15] real testimonials, survey responses, or social media comments from our supporters. Analyze them and extract:

- 1. The top 3 emotional pain points people describe experiencing BEFORE they engaged with our organization.*
- 2. The exact phrases they use to describe what changed after engaging with us. Pull direct language, not summaries.*
- 3. Any words or phrases that appear 3 or more times across multiple responses.*

Format the results as a table. Then write 3 headline options for our donation page using only language pulled from these responses.

HOW I USE THIS AT SEEDSCALE

I run this prompt at the start of every new client engagement. Before writing a single piece of copy, I collect donor testimonials, supporter emails, and social media comments. The language Claude extracts becomes the foundation of all messaging. One client's donation page headline changed from an internal-facing mission statement to a phrase pulled directly from 4 separate donor responses. The page was never A/B tested against the old version because the team recognized the new language immediately as the way their donors actually talk.

PRO TIP

The more raw and unedited the source material, the better. Survey open-text fields and social media comments work better than polished testimonials because the language is unfiltered.

02

The Competitor Campaign Reverse-Engineer

Deconstruct why competitor campaigns work and apply those structural patterns to your own.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Most nonprofit marketers watch what peer organizations do and either ignore it or try to copy the surface-level execution. Neither approach is useful. What matters is the underlying structure: why a specific email subject line works, what psychological trigger an ad exploits, how a landing page sequences information to reduce friction. This prompt deconstructs that structure so you can apply the mechanics without copying the content.

THE PROMPT

I am pasting in [3-5] marketing assets from peer organizations in our space. These could be fundraising emails, social ads, landing pages, or direct mail pieces. For each one, identify:

- 1. The hook mechanism. How does it capture attention in the first 3 seconds or the first line?*
- 2. The core emotional trigger. What feeling does it activate in the reader?*
- 3. The offer structure. What is the reader being asked to do and how is the ask framed?*
- 4. The CTA language. What specific words are used to prompt action?*
- 5. The implicit assumption about the audience. What must be true about the reader for this piece to resonate?*

Then write 3 original variations for MY organization [describe your org, audience, and campaign goal] that use the strongest structural patterns you identified. Do not copy any language. Apply the mechanics with entirely original copy in our voice.

HOW WE USE THIS FOR CLIENTS

When onboarding a new nonprofit client, I pull successful campaigns from 3-5 organizations in their sector. Feeding these to Claude surfaces patterns the client has never noticed. One development director told me she had been studying a peer organization's year-end campaign for two years but never understood why it outperformed hers. The deconstruction revealed the peer used a single-beneficiary story in every email while my client led with organizational achievements. The structural shift alone changed the trajectory of their next campaign.

PRO TIP

Focus on assets that have been running for a long time or that organizations keep repeating.

Longevity signals that something is working. One-off campaigns are harder to learn from because you cannot tell if they succeeded.

03

The 10-Subject-Line Generator

Generate categorically different email subject lines with built-in reasoning for A/B testing.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Most people ask AI for subject line ideas and get 10 variations of the same approach. This prompt forces categorical diversity by requiring specific types of hooks. You end up with genuinely different angles to test instead of a list of synonyms.

THE PROMPT

Write 10 subject lines for this email [paste the email body below]. Structure them as follows:

2 curiosity-gap lines (make the reader feel they are missing something)

2 number-led lines (open with a specific stat or figure)

2 lines that include the word "you" or "your" (make it personal)

2 contrarian lines (challenge an assumption the reader holds)

2 ultra-short lines (5 words or fewer)

Score each one from 1 to 10 for likely open rate and explain in one sentence why you gave that score. Then recommend your top 3 for A/B testing and explain which audience segment each would resonate with most.

HOW I USE THIS EVERY WEEK

This is the prompt I use most often. Every client email, every newsletter, every campaign blast goes through this process before anything sends. I pick the top 2-3 and A/B test them. Over time, the data reveals which category of hook works best for each audience segment. For nonprofit donor audiences, I have found that curiosity-gap and ultra-short lines consistently outperform number-led lines. That insight only emerged because the categories forced me to test approaches I would have skipped on instinct.

PRO TIP

Claude's scoring will not always match real-world results, and it does not need to. The value is in the reasoning. When you read WHY Claude scored a subject line high or low, it trains your own instinct about what drives opens.

04

The Content Multiplier

Turn one piece of content into 12+ platform-specific assets without lazy reformatting.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Creating content is not the bottleneck for most nonprofit marketing teams. Distribution is. You write a great blog post or produce a strong video and then it goes on one channel and dies. This prompt forces genuine reimagining for each platform instead of copy-pasting the same text with a different character count.

THE PROMPT

I am providing a [blog post / video transcript / campaign brief] below. Repurpose it into the following formats. Do not simply shorten or summarize. Reimagine each piece for the platform and the audience behavior on that platform:

- 1. 7 standalone social media posts (each should function as a complete thought, not a teaser)*
- 2. A LinkedIn post using this structure: one-sentence hook creating a knowledge gap, 4-5 short paragraphs with a specific story or numbers, closing with one easy-to-answer question*
- 3. An Instagram carousel outline: 8-10 slides, one key point per slide, with a hook slide and a CTA slide*
- 4. 3 email subject lines with preview text*
- 5. A 30-second vertical video script with hook (first 3 seconds), body, and CTA*

For each piece, note which audience segment it targets and what action it is designed to drive.

A DAILY WORKFLOW

I built a Claude-powered Slack bot for a nonprofit client that allows any department to request marketing copy directly in Slack. The bot is trained on the organization's brand voice and messaging framework. This multiplier prompt is essentially what the bot runs every time a content piece needs to be distributed across channels. What used to take a copywriter 4-6 hours of reformatting per piece now takes minutes. The team reclaimed 10-20 hours per week across departments.

PRO TIP

The instruction 'do not simply shorten' is the most important line in this prompt. Without it, Claude defaults to compression instead of genuine platform-native reimagining.

05

The Fundraising Email Draft Machine

Generate a complete fundraising or campaign email in your voice, structured around direct response principles.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Most nonprofit fundraising emails fail for the same reason: they lead with the organization instead of the donor. They describe what the org is doing instead of making the reader feel the urgency, see the impact, and understand why their specific action matters right now. This prompt builds the email around direct response structure so every element earns its place.

THE PROMPT

Write a fundraising email for [organization name] targeting [donor segment: first-time donors / recurring donors / lapsed donors / major gift prospects].

Campaign: [describe the specific campaign or appeal]

Gift amount to anchor: [dollar amount]

Deadline: [if applicable]

Structure the email as follows:

- 1. Subject line: 3 options (one curiosity-based, one urgency-based, one personal).*
- 2. Opening line: Start with a single sentence about the DONOR or the beneficiary. Do not open with the organization name or the word 'we.'*
- 3. Story: 2-3 sentences about one specific person whose life changes because of this campaign. First name. Concrete detail. No statistics in this section.*
- 4. The ask: Clearly state the gift amount and exactly what it does. Tie the dollar amount to a tangible outcome.*
- 5. Urgency: One sentence explaining why now, not later.*
- 6. CTA: One clear button/link with action-oriented text (not 'click here').*
- 7. P.S. line: Restate the deadline or add one additional reason to give.*

Tone: Warm and direct. No guilt. No jargon. Write at an 8th-grade reading level. Keep the full email under 250 words.

HOW I USE THIS FOR CLIENT CAMPAIGNS

Every fundraising email I produce for clients starts with this prompt. I customize the segment, campaign details, and gift level, then generate 3 variations. I edit for brand voice, swap in real beneficiary details, and the email is ready for review in 15 minutes instead of 2 hours. For one organization, applying this direct response structure to year-end emails contributed to a 53% increase in digital donations year over year.

PRO TIP

The constraint 'do not open with the organization name or the word we' is the single instruction that most improves output quality. It forces donor-centric framing from the first line.

06

The Brand Voice Encoder

Teach AI your exact voice so every piece of output sounds like your team wrote it.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Generic AI output is the number one complaint from marketing teams. The solution is not better prompting on individual requests. It is encoding your brand identity once so AI references it automatically. This prompt creates a persistent voice profile that transforms Claude from a generic writing assistant into a trained member of your communications team.

THE PROMPT

I am going to give you the building blocks of our organization's voice. Your job is to internalize this and apply it to everything I ask you to write in this conversation.

Brand voice description: *[paste 2-3 sentences describing your tone. Example: 'Direct and warm. We lead with impact, not institutional language. We use specific numbers over vague claims. We never open with the organization. We close with consequence, not hype.']*

Words and phrases we NEVER use: *[list 5-10. Example: 'innovative, synergy, leverage, circle back, deep dive, stakeholder, at the end of the day']*

Words and phrases we ALWAYS use: *[list 5-10 that characterize your voice]*

5 examples of our best-performing content: *[paste real pieces: emails, social posts, or web copy that represent your voice at its best]*

Now confirm you understand this voice by writing a 3-sentence description of how you will write for us. Then write a sample 100-word fundraising email so I can verify the voice is calibrated before we proceed.

THE CORE OF MY AI WORKFLOW

I completed a 100-question voice profile exercise and use it as the foundation of a Claude Project that houses all of Seedscale's brand context. Every piece of content generated inside that project sounds like me. When I build custom AI tools for clients, this is the first step: encoding their voice. I built a Slack-based copywriting bot for one organization that any

department could use. Because the bot was trained on their voice profile and best-performing content, the output was consistent whether the request came from the fundraising team, the comms team, or the program team. The voice encoding is what makes it work.

PRO TIP

Save this as a Claude Project with your voice profile, best content examples, and audience descriptions uploaded as project knowledge. You will never have to re-explain your brand again.

07

The Viral Content Reverse-Engineer

Deconstruct why high-performing content went viral and build a repeatable formula for your niche.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Viral content is not random. It follows structural patterns that can be identified, studied, and applied. This prompt takes content that performed exceptionally well in your space and extracts the mechanics so you can replicate the structure without copying the execution. I use this to study what works across social platforms and build content calendars rooted in proven patterns rather than guesswork.

THE PROMPT

I am pasting in [3-5] pieces of high-performing content from creators or organizations in my space. These could be Instagram Reels, TikTok videos, LinkedIn posts, or email campaigns that generated unusually high engagement. For each piece, analyze:

- 1. The hook: What technique is used in the first 1-3 seconds or first line to stop the scroll? Categorize it (curiosity gap, bold claim, pattern interrupt, direct address, shocking stat).*
- 2. The structure: Map the content beat by beat. How does it sequence information to maintain attention?*
- 3. The emotional arc: What feeling does it create at the beginning vs. the end? Does it resolve tension or leave it open?*
- 4. The shareability trigger: Why would someone send this to a colleague or save it? Is it identity-affirming, practically useful, or emotionally resonant?*
- 5. The CTA mechanics: What is the viewer asked to do and how is that ask embedded?*

Then identify the 3 strongest patterns across all pieces and write 5 original content concepts for [my niche/topic] that apply those patterns. Include a hook, structure outline, and format recommendation for each.

HOW I BUILD CONTENT CALENDARS

Before creating any content strategy for Seedscale or for clients, I study what is already working. I pull the top-performing Reels, posts, and emails from adjacent creators and nonprofit organizations, feed them through this prompt, and extract the patterns. The content calendar is then built on proven structural mechanics rather than intuition. This is the

difference between hoping something works and engineering content around patterns that have already been validated by real audience behavior.

PRO TIP

Focus on content from your specific niche or adjacent niches. Patterns from unrelated industries rarely transfer well. The structure of a viral fitness Reel is different from the structure of a viral nonprofit Reel, even if both use similar hooks.

What Comes Next

Ready to Go Deeper?

These 7 prompts are the starting point. The full AI Nonprofit Playbook covers the complete framework: fundraising automation, content systems, donor engagement workflows, and the AI tools that make it all run.

Download the AI Nonprofit Playbook (free)
seedscale.agency

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